SEO Changelog: Private Crab Island Charter

URL: https://crabislandtikitoursdestin.com/charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/ | WP page ID 252 (Elementor, Rank Math) | Last modified September 6, 2026 | Audit date: October 28, 2026 | Page 2 of the site queue

Method: content, headings, links, images and SEO meta were pulled from WordPress through the site connector. The live URL could not be loaded from the audit environment, so rendered-page checks (speed, tags firing, schema output) are listed as checks to run.

1. Summary

Item	Current state
Role	Main product page for the site's core service. Should rank for "private crab island charter", "crab island tiki boat" and "private boat charter destin".
SEO title	Private Crab Island Charter in Destin, FL | Captain Included (60 characters, good)
Meta description	223 characters. Google will cut it around 155 to 160.
H1	Private Crab Island Charter Destin, Florida (missing "in", reads as keyword stuffing)
Body copy	About 650 words. Intro calls the boat a "pontoon" while every other line says tiki boat.
Product cards	6 cards: 4-hour $800, 6-hour $1,200, 8-hour $1,600, 5-hour $1,000 (under "Other Tour Options"), sunset 1.5-hour $400, public 4-hour $60. Each card also shows a second "2 Hours" label.
Internal links	7 internal links. 2 go to older blog posts that duplicate newer guide pages. 1 goes to /elementor-863/. No link to the home page, bachelorette page, sunset page or the About Crab Island guides.
Images	8 images, 7 with empty alt text. No featured image.

2. Critical fixes

#	Issue	Fix
1	P1 Sunset card image goes to the wrong product	The Private Sunset Tour image links to FareHarbor item 744100 (Crab Island & Sunset, $1,200), but its Book Now button links to item 712850 (sunset, $400). Change the image link to item 712850.
2	P1 Durations don't match	The booking text says "Choose from 3, 4, 5, 6, or 8-hour private charters." The cards show 4, 5, 6 and 8 hours, and there is no 3-hour card. Either add a 3-hour card or remove "3" from the text. Every card also has a second "2 Hours" icon, which reads as a contradiction (a 6-hour trip labeled "2 Hours"). Remove that icon or relabel it with what it actually means.

3	P1 The 5-hour charter is hidden under "Other Tour Options"	The $1,000 five-hour trip is the same product as the other three but sits with the upsells, and its H3 repeats the page H1 ("Private Crab Island Charter"). Move it into the main charter lineup and rename it "5-Hour Private Crab Island Charter".
4	P1 Price conflicts with other pages	This page: sunset from $400, public from $60. Home: sunset from $600, public from $30. Guides: private from $900. Confirm in FareHarbor and match everywhere (also flagged in the Home changelog).
5	P1 "Pontoon" in the intro	The first paragraph says "aboard your own private pontoon charter." The product is a tiki boat, and the site has a page arguing tiki boat over pontoon. Replace with the rewrite in section 5.
6	P2 Hidden characters in headings	"Your Private Crab Island Adventure Starts Here!" ends with a zero-width space (U+200B), and the "Private Crab Island & Sunset Cruise" H3 ends with a line break. Retype both headings in Elementor.

3. SEO title and meta description

Field	Current	New
SEO title	Private Crab Island Charter in Destin, FL | Captain Included	Keep, or test **Private Crab Island Charter in Destin, FL | Tiki Boat for 18** (60 characters)
Meta description	Experience a memorable day aboard a private crab island charter in Destin. Captain included, bathroom onboard, and room for up to 18 guests. Bring your favorite people, relax and make memories while we take care of the rest!	**Private Crab Island charter in Destin on a tiki boat for up to 18. USCG captain and bathroom onboard. 4, 5, 6 and 8 hour trips from Destin Harbor.** (146 characters)
Focus keyword	Primary: **private crab island charter**. Secondary: crab island tiki boat charter, private boat charter destin, crab island boat rental with captain, half day crab island charter.	
URL	/charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/ is fine. Keep it, but publish or redirect the /charters/ parent (page 59 is a draft).	

4. Heading structure

Current

```
H1  Private Crab Island Charter Destin, Florida
H2  Your Private Crab Island Adventure Starts Here!   (contains zero-width space)
  H3  Private Crab Island Tiki Tour                  (4 hr)
  H3  Private Crab Island & Sunset Cruise            (6 hr)
  H3  Full-Day Private Crab Island Charter           (8 hr)
H2  Book Your Private Crab Island Charter
H2  Your Day At Crab Island!
H2  Included:
H2  Reviews!
H2  Other Tour Options
  H3  Private Crab Island Charter                    (5 hr, duplicates H1 topic)
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  H3  Private Sunset Tour
  H3  Public Crab Island Charter
H2  Learn More!
  H3  Learn More About Crab Island:
  H3  Learn More About Us:
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New

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H1  Private Crab Island Charter in Destin, FL
H2  Choose Your Charter Length
  H3  4-Hour Private Crab Island Charter
  H3  5-Hour Private Crab Island Charter
  H3  6-Hour Crab Island and Sunset Charter
  H3  8-Hour Full-Day Crab Island Charter
H2  Check Dates and Book Your Charter
H2  What Your Day at Crab Island Looks Like
  H3  Boarding at Destin Harbor
  H3  Anchoring at the Sandbar
  H3  Cruising Back (or Staying for Sunset)
H2  What's Included With Every Private Charter
H2  What to Bring on Your Charter
H2  Private Crab Island Charter FAQs
  H3  (one per question)
H2  Reviews From Our Charter Guests
H2  More Ways to See Destin by Boat
  H3  Private Sunset Dolphin Cruise
  H3  Public Pay-Per-Seat Crab Island Trip
H2  Plan Your Crab Island Trip
```

5. Content rewrites (paste-ready)

Facts below come from the site: tiki boat, up to 18 guests, USCG-licensed captain, bathroom onboard, Destin Harbor departure, card lengths and prices as currently listed. Confirm prices in FareHarbor before publishing.

Intro (under H1)

> Spend the day at Crab Island on a tiki boat that's reserved for your group alone. Your USCG-licensed captain drives, anchors and handles the trip back from the sandbar, so everyone else can swim, float, play music and relax in the clear, shallow water.
>
> The boat seats up to 18 guests, has shade under the tiki roof and a bathroom onboard. Choose 4, 5, 6 or 8 hours, all leaving from Destin Harbor. It works for family vacations, birthdays, reunions and bachelorette parties.
>
> *Button: Check Availability*

H2: Choose Your Charter Length (add a comparison table above the cards)

Charter	Length	From	Best for
Private Crab Island Charter	4 hours	$800	First visit, families with young kids
Private Crab Island Charter	5 hours	$1,000	Groups who want a longer swim without a full day

Crab Island and Sunset Charter	6 hours	$1,200	Afternoon at the sandbar, sunset on the way back
Full-Day Crab Island Charter	8 hours	$1,600	Large groups and celebrations

H3: 4-Hour Private Crab Island Charter
A half day at Crab Island with time to swim, float and visit the vendors before heading back to the harbor. The most popular choice for families and first-time visitors.

H3: 5-Hour Private Crab Island Charter
One more hour on the sandbar. Good for groups who want a slower pace, a long lunch on the water or more time to explore.

H3: 6-Hour Crab Island and Sunset Charter
Spend the afternoon at Crab Island, then cruise the Emerald Coast and look for dolphins as the sun goes down. Two trips in one booking.

H3: 8-Hour Full-Day Crab Island Charter
A full day with your own captain. Visit Crab Island, cruise Destin Harbor and stop along the shoreline. Built for big groups and celebrations.

H2: Check Dates and Book Your Charter

Pick a date in the calendar to see open start times for each charter length. Your booking reserves the whole boat for your group. Your confirmation email includes the meeting spot at Destin Harbor and what to bring.

H2: What Your Day at Crab Island Looks Like

H3: Boarding at Destin Harbor
Meet your captain at the dock, load coolers and bags, and get a quick safety briefing. *(Add check-in time, for example "Please arrive 15 minutes early," once confirmed.)*

H3: Anchoring at the Sandbar
Crab Island is about half a mile from the harbor, just north of the Marler Bridge. Your captain anchors in shallow water, usually 2 to 4 feet deep depending on the tide, and your group is free to swim, float and visit the floating food and drink vendors.

H3: Cruising Back (or Staying for Sunset)
On longer charters, your captain can cruise the harbor and shoreline before returning. On the 6-hour trip, you'll head out for sunset and dolphin watching on the way in.

H2: What's Included With Every Private Charter

- USCG-licensed captain for the full trip
- Private use of the tiki boat for up to 18 guests
- Onboard bathroom
- Shaded seating under the tiki roof

- Bluetooth music *(confirm; the intro mentions music)*

H2: What to Bring on Your Charter

Sunscreen, water shoes, towels, snacks, drinks in cans or plastic (no glass) and cash for the floating vendors. See the full Crab Island packing list.

H2: Private Crab Island Charter FAQs (Rank Math FAQ block)

How many people can come on a private charter? Up to 18 guests plus the captain.

Is there a bathroom on the boat? Yes, the tiki boat has an onboard bathroom.

Can we bring food and drinks? *(Confirm the alcohol policy. The Bachelorette page meta says BYOB-friendly.)* No glass containers.

Are kids allowed? Yes, charters are for all ages. Read Is Crab Island family friendly?

What happens if the weather is bad? *(One-sentence summary of the weather policy, linking to the FAQs page.)*

How much does a private Crab Island charter cost? Private charters start at $800 for 4 hours. See how much it costs to go to Crab Island for a comparison with shuttles and pontoon rentals.

H2: More Ways to See Destin by Boat

H3: Private Sunset Dolphin Cruise
A 1.5-hour evening cruise for your group of up to 18, with time to look for dolphins along the way. *Buttons: Book Now (item 712850) and Sunset Cruise Details*

H3: Public Pay-Per-Seat Crab Island Trip
Traveling light? Our sister company, Bikkini Bottom Boat Tours, sells individual seats on a 4-hour Crab Island trip. *Buttons: Book a Seat and Public Tour Details*

6. Internal linking

Anchor text	Target	Action
Crab Island packing list	/about-crab-island/what-to-bring-to-crab-island/	Replace link to post 773 (/what-to-bring-to-crab-island/)
best time to visit Crab Island	/about-crab-island/best-time-to-visit-crab-island/	Replace link to post 910
tide	/high-tide-vs-low-tide-at-crab-island/	Keep, move into "Anchoring" copy
Is Crab Island family friendly?	/is-crab-island-family-friendly/	Keep, move into FAQ
bachelorette parties	/crab-island-bachelorette-party-destin/	Add in intro

how much it costs to go to Crab Island	/about-crab-island/how-much-does-crab-island-cost/	Add in FAQ
Tiki boat or pontoon rental?	/about-crab-island/tiki-boat-vs-pontoon-rental-crab-island/	Add in Plan Your Trip
How deep is the water at Crab Island?	/about-crab-island/how-deep-is-crab-island/	Add in Plan Your Trip
Where is Crab Island?	/about-crab-island/where-is-crab-island/	Add in Plan Your Trip
Sunset Cruise Details	/charters/private-sunset-cruise-in-destin-fl/	Add to sunset card
Public Tour Details	/public-crab-island-boat-tours-destin/ (renamed 892)	Add to public card
Meet Captain Bill	/captain-bill/ (renamed 863)	Update from /elementor-863/
Crab Island Tiki Tours FAQs	/crab-island-tiki-tours-faqs/	Keep

Inbound: the Home page's private tiki card and hero image should both link here (see Home changelog). Each About Crab Island guide should link here with anchor text like "private Crab Island charter".

7. Images

File	Current alt	New alt
image-15.webp (top)	Private Crab Island Charter	Private tiki boat charter at Crab Island in Destin, FL
20250405_130710-rotated-1.webp	(empty)	Group swimming next to the tiki boat at Crab Island
image-6-1.webp (used twice)	(empty)	Tiki boat cruising Destin Harbor at sunset. Use a different photo on the second card.
image-3-1.webp	(empty)	Full-day private charter group on the tiki boat
image-11.webp	(empty)	Guests floating at the Crab Island sandbar
image-19.webp	(empty)	Private 5-hour Crab Island charter on the tiki boat
IMG_9253-e1787491747500.jpg	(empty)	Bikkini Bottom public boat at Crab Island. Convert to WebP.

Alt text above is a template. Adjust each one to what the photo shows. Set a featured image for social sharing.

8. Technical

#	Item	Action

1	P1 Product schema	Add a Rank Math Schema (Product or custom TouristTrip) with four Offers: 4 hr $800, 5 hr $1,000, 6 hr $1,200, 8 hr $1,600, priceCurrency USD, availability InStock, url to the booking flow. Add aggregateRating only if it matches visible Google reviews on the page. Add FAQPage via the Rank Math FAQ block.
2	P1 Breadcrumbs	Enable Rank Math breadcrumbs. The path Home > Charters > Private Crab Island Charter needs a live /charters/ page.
3	P2 FareHarbor calendar embed	The `[fareharbor ... type="responsive"]` calendar loads a heavy iframe. Make sure it sits below the fold and that the FareHarbor script is not loaded on pages that don't use it.
4	P2 Duplicate image	image-6-1.webp is used on two different products. Use unique photos so Google Images and visitors can tell the trips apart.
5	P3 Speed check	Run PageSpeed Insights mobile on this URL after the calendar and reviews widget load.

9. Tracking

Use the sitewide setup from the Home changelog (FareHarbor GA4 integration, cross-domain, purchase key event). Page-specific additions:

Event	Setup
book_now_click	Parameters: `tour_name`, `fareharbor_item` (643424 4 hr, 753976 5 hr, 744100 6 hr, 746740 8 hr, 712850 sunset, 615407 public), `button_location` (hero, card, calendar). This shows which lengths people click versus which they buy.
calendar_interaction	FareHarbor's GA4 integration reports its own booking-flow events. Check in GA4 DebugView that they arrive with the same client ID (cross-domain working).
outbound_click	Bikkini Bottom FareHarbor link (item 615407), with `partner=bikkini_bottom`.
scroll / FAQ	GA4 enhanced measurement scroll is enough. Optional: `faq_open` if the FAQ uses an accordion.

10. Changelog

#	Area	Change	Priority	Status
1	Links	Fix sunset card image link (744100 to 712850)	P1	To do
2	Content	Fix duration text (3-hour) and remove stray "2 Hours" icon on each card	P1	To do
3	Content	Move 5-hour charter into main lineup, rename H3	P1	To do

4	Content	Confirm and align sunset and public prices with Home	P1	To do
5	Content	Replace "pontoon" intro with new intro	P1	To do
6	Meta	Shorten meta description to 146 characters	P1	To do
7	Technical	Product/TouristTrip schema with 4 Offers plus FAQPage	P1	To do
8	Headings	New H1, H2 and H3 outline; remove zero-width space and line break	P2	To do
9	Content	Add comparison table, day timeline, What to Bring and FAQ sections	P2	To do
10	Links	Swap old blog links for guide pages, add 8 new internal links, update Captain Bill URL	P2	To do
11	Images	Alt text on 7 images, unique photo per card, featured image	P2	To do
12	Tracking	book_now_click with item IDs, outbound_click for Bikkini Bottom	P2	To do
13	Technical	Breadcrumbs, calendar placement, PageSpeed check	P3	To do